

Politics News Digest - 2026-09-29

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--- India ---

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/>

1. Future polls must use pre-SIR voter list, say civil society groups, demanding a full rollback of the SIR

Civil society groups are joining the voter-roll dispute, asking that upcoming elections use the rolls from before the Special Intensive Revision.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/future-polls-must-use-pre-sir-voter-list-say-civil-society-groups-demanding-a-full-rollback-of-the-sir/article71520444.ece>

2. Rahul Gandhi visits JJ cluster in Bela Estate, questions deletion of voters' names from SIR draft roll

The Leader of the Opposition is highlighting on the ground in Delhi how names removed from the draft voter roll affect residents.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/cities/Delhi/rahul-gandhi-visits-jj-cluster-in-bela-estate-questions-deletion-of-voters-names-from-sir-draft-roll/article71521391.ece>

3. BJP accuses Opposition leaders of conspiring to derail India's progress

The ruling party is hitting back at the Opposition as the political fight over the Election Commission and other issues intensifies.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/bjp-accuses-opposition-leaders-of-conspiring-to-derail-indias-progress/article71520282.ece>

4. Kharge slams BJP for 'humiliating' the people, says 'arrogance of power' has peaked

The Congress president is sharpening the party's attack on the ruling BJP.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/kharge-slams-bjp-for-humiliating-the-people-says-arrogance-of-power-has-peaked/article71519582.ece>

5. States stumped as demography panel seeks religion-wise data on vehicles, schools, voters

A central demography panel's request for religion-wise data across several categories has left state governments unsure how to respond.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/states-stumped-as-demography-panel-seeks-religion-wise-data-on-vehicles-schools-voters/article71520565.ece>

6. Supreme Court asks how children can have social media accounts, as underlying contracts are legally void

The court is questioning the legal basis for minors' social media accounts, which could shape future regulation of platforms.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-asks-how-children-can-have-social-media-accounts-as-underlying-contracts-are-legally-void/article71520970.ece>

7. BJP's SC/ST Lok Sabha MPs took part in fewer debates than House average and party peers

A data analysis of parliamentary participation finds the ruling party's SC/ST MPs spoke in fewer Lok Sabha debates than others.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/bjps-scst-lok-sabha-mps-took-part-in-fewer-debates-than-house-average-and-party-peers/article71520138.ece>

8. Over 40 modules of Shahzad Bhatti network busted, 350 held across 15 States: Amit Shah

The Home Minister reports a large multi-State security crackdown on a network linked to Shahzad Bhatti.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/over-40-modules-of-shahzad-bhatti-network-busted-350-held-across-15-states-amit-shah/article71520689.ece>

9. Congress to hold self-respect meeting over Haldwani 'purification' ritual

Congress is mobilising over a 'purification' ritual in Haldwani, Uttarakhand, which it treats as an affront.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/congress-to-hold-self-respect-meeting-over-haldwani-purification-ritual/article71516340.ece>

10. India, Kazakhstan to hold joint counter-terrorism exercise KAZIND from September 28

The joint military exercise reflects ongoing defence cooperation between India and Kazakhstan.

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/india-kazakhstan-to-hold-joint-counter-terrorism-exercise-kazind-from-september-28/article71519886.ece>

--- International ---

Source: <https://www.bbc.com/news/world>

1. Stand-up comic released after being convicted of insulting Erdogan

Turkish comedian Deniz Goktas was freed for time served but faces a travel ban, keeping attention on Turkey's laws against insulting the president.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c8zxzlqwzw0eo>

2. Iran court upholds lashes sentence for singer who performed without hijab

The ruling against singer Parastoo Ahmadi shows Iran's courts continuing to enforce dress-code rules on performers.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/crn45ed1kqqgo>

3. Stuck between superpowers: How Australia navigates the China-US rivalry

Australia is weighing security worries about China's military against its reliance on China as its biggest trade partner.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c61wxyzr4rwyo>

4. Twelve women have been killed in one part of South Africa since July. Here's what we know so far

President Cyril Ramaphosa has called the killings a stain on the national conscience, putting pressure on the government to respond.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c6m27dprvzv7o>

5. Remains of dozens of suspected kidnap victims found in Nigerian forests

Police found the remains of at least 28 people, underlining Nigeria's kidnapping and security crisis.

<https://www.bbc.com/news/articles/c6e30x757nx4o>

Top themes today: SIR voter-roll dispute and BJP-Congress sparring, Supreme Court scrutiny of social media and child protection, state limits on speech and dress (Turkey, Iran), middle powers navigating US-China rivalry